ENGLISH C1 · ADVANCED GRAMMAR

Auxiliary emphasis and fronting

Use emphatic auxiliaries and selective fronting to correct assumptions, reinforce contrast and control information focus. The lesson connects form, meaning, register and real editorial decisions rather than treating the pattern as an isolated rule.

THE CENTRAL IDEA

Use auxiliary emphasis and fronting to mark correction or contrast without changing the underlying time reference while preserving the intended meaning and register.

Use emphatic auxiliaries and selective fronting to correct assumptions, reinforce contrast and control information focus.

MODEL

The first proposal did address the immediate risk.

do/does/did + base | fronted complement + clause

6 GUIDED STAGES · 30 LEARNING DECISIONS

This complete guide combines explanation, visual reasoning, practice and feedback. Separate exercise and answer-key editions are also available from the lesson page.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

OUTCOME 1

01

Recognise the main auxiliary emphasis and fronting patterns in authentic contexts.

OUTCOME 2

02

Choose a form that accurately expresses mark correction or contrast without changing the underlying time reference.

OUTCOME 3

03

Avoid errors that change time, agency, emphasis or speaker commitment.

OUTCOME 4

04

Use the structure appropriately in debate, clarification, persuasive speech and edited prose.

Build meaning before form

Use emphatic auxiliaries and selective fronting to correct assumptions, reinforce contrast and control information focus.

What auxiliary emphasis and fronting communicates

Use emphatic auxiliaries and selective fronting to correct assumptions, reinforce contrast and control information focus.

The central purpose is to mark correction or contrast without changing the underlying time reference. A successful choice therefore preserves the proposition while making the intended relationship, viewpoint or degree of commitment visible to the reader.

The first proposal did address the immediate risk.	a correction to an explicit or implied denial
Useful the guide may be, but complete it is not.	a strong contrast between two evaluated qualities
This limitation, we cannot ignore.	an established topic placed before the comment

How the pattern is built

Use this working formula: do/does/did + base | fronted complement + clause. The formula is a decision path: it identifies the trigger, the clause architecture and the element that carries tense or modality.

The model “The first proposal did address the immediate risk.” shows the complete pattern in context. Rebuild the sentence from meaning to form instead of translating each word independently.

Choice	Structure	Example
Corrective do	do/does/did + base verb	The first proposal did address the immediate risk.
Contrastive complement	complement + subject + verb	Useful the guide may be, but complete it is not.
Object topicalisation	object + subject + verb	This limitation, we cannot ignore.

Choose by meaning, not by surface similarity

Neighbouring structures may contain similar words but perform different jobs. Compare the three reference patterns and name the intended effect before completing the sentence.

A reliable answer explains both why the chosen form works and why a plausible alternative would change the meaning, time relation, information focus or level of certainty.

Meaning	Best route
a correction to an explicit or implied denial	Corrective do
a strong contrast between two evaluated qualities	Contrastive complement
an established topic placed before the comment	Object topicalisation

Register, discourse and editorial control

This grammar is especially useful in debate, clarification, persuasive speech and edited prose. Its value comes from helping the reader process a relationship efficiently, not from making the sentence sound artificially complex.

After editing, check recoverability, natural word order and consistency with the surrounding paragraph. If the marked structure creates ambiguity, return to a fuller or more neutral clause.

Reason through the pattern

The visual map moves from communicative purpose to structural trigger, then to the final clause. It keeps meaning and form visible at the same time so the learner can justify every choice.

01	02	03	04
do/does/did	base	fronted complement	clause

DECIDE IN THIS ORDER

STEP 1

Decision 1

Identify the communicative purpose before selecting a form: mark correction or contrast without changing the underlying time reference.

STEP 2

Decision 2

Locate the structural trigger and match it to one of the reference patterns.

STEP 3

Decision 3

Check time reference, clause relationships, agency and speaker commitment.

STEP 4

Decision 4

Read the complete sentence in context and confirm that its register suits debate, clarification, persuasive speech and edited prose.

STEP 5

Decision 5

Compare the result with a neutral alternative and keep the marked form only when it adds useful meaning.

Compare forms and meanings

Use the table to justify each structural choice.

Pattern	Form	Model
Corrective do	do/does/did + base verb	The first proposal did address the immediate risk.
Contrastive complement	complement + subject + verb	Useful the guide may be, but complete it is not.
Object topicalisation	object + subject + verb	This limitation, we cannot ignore.

EXAMPLES AT A GLANCE

The first proposal did address the immediate risk.	a correction to an explicit or implied denial
Useful the guide may be, but complete it is not.	a strong contrast between two evaluated qualities
This limitation, we cannot ignore.	an established topic placed before the comment

COMMON ERRORS

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not combine emphatic did with a past-tense main verb.

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not front a complement unless the surrounding contrast licenses the marked order.

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not add subject-auxiliary inversion after ordinary object fronting.

Recognition in context

Choose the sentence whose grammar matches the stated communicative purpose.

A1 · MEANING DECISION 1

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: a correction to an explicit or implied denial?

OPTIONS The first proposal did address the immediate risk. · Useful the guide may be, but complete it is not. · This limitation, we cannot ignore.

A2 · MEANING DECISION 2

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: a strong contrast between two evaluated qualities?

OPTIONS Useful the guide may be, but complete it is not. · This limitation, we cannot ignore. · The first proposal did address the immediate risk.

A3 · MEANING DECISION 3

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: an established topic placed before the comment?

OPTIONS This limitation, we cannot ignore. · The first proposal did address the immediate risk. · Useful the guide may be, but complete it is not.

A4 · INTERPRETATION 4

What does “The first proposal did address the immediate risk.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS a correction to an explicit or implied denial · a strong contrast between two evaluated qualities · an established topic placed before the comment

A5 · INTERPRETATION 5

What does “Useful the guide may be, but complete it is not.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS a strong contrast between two evaluated qualities · an established topic placed before the comment · a correction to an explicit or implied denial

A6 · INTERPRETATION 6

What does “This limitation, we cannot ignore.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS an established topic placed before the comment · a correction to an explicit or implied denial · a strong contrast between two evaluated qualities

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Form and function

Identify both the structural family and the meaning carried by each model.

B1 · FORM AND FUNCTION 1

“The first proposal did address the immediate risk.” uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Corrective do / Contrastive complement / Object topicalisation · Gap 2: a correction to an explicit or implied denial / a strong contrast between two evaluated qualities / an established topic placed before the comment

B2 · FORM AND FUNCTION 2

“Useful the guide may be, but complete it is not.” uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Contrastive complement / Object topicalisation / Corrective do · Gap 2: a strong contrast between two evaluated qualities / an established topic placed before the comment / a correction to an explicit or implied denial

B3 · FORM AND FUNCTION 3

“This limitation, we cannot ignore.” uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Object topicalisation / Corrective do / Contrastive complement · Gap 2: an established topic placed before the comment / a correction to an explicit or implied denial / a strong contrast between two evaluated qualities

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

03 · PRACTICE STAGE

Guided discourse choices

Maintain accurate form and meaning across a connected sequence of decisions.

C1 · EDITORIAL PLANNING

Choose the model that expresses a correction to an explicit or implied denial: _____. Choose the model that expresses a strong contrast between two evaluated qualities: _____. Choose the model that expresses an established topic placed before the comment: _____. Choose the model built with do/does/did + base verb: _____. Choose the model built with complement + subject + verb: _____. Choose the model built with object + subject + verb: _____.

_____
_____

WORD BANK

Available forms

The first proposal did address the immediate risk. · This limitation, we cannot ignore. · Useful the guide may be, but complete it is not.

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Open reconstruction

Recover the missing structural trigger without a word bank.

D1 · INDEPENDENT RECONSTRUCTION

The first proposal _____ the immediate risk. _____, but complete it is not. _____, we cannot ignore. State the full structural pattern for Corrective do: _____. State the full structural pattern for Contrastive complement: _____.

_____
_____
_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Controlled transformation

Rewrite the neutral source so that it performs the requested advanced function.

E1 · TRANSFORMATION 1

Rewrite “The first proposal addressed the risk, contrary to the claim.” using the Corrective do pattern to express a correction to an explicit or implied denial.

_____
_____

E2 · TRANSFORMATION 2

Rewrite “The guide may be useful, but it is not complete.” using the Contrastive complement pattern to express a strong contrast between two evaluated qualities.

_____
_____

E3 · TRANSFORMATION 3

Rewrite “We cannot ignore this limitation.” using the Object topicalisation pattern to express an established topic placed before the comment.

_____
_____

E4 · TRANSFORMATION 4

Rewrite “The first proposal addressed the risk, contrary to the claim.” using the Corrective do pattern to express a correction to an explicit or implied denial.

_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Communicative production

Use the grammar independently in realistic academic, professional and conversational contexts.

F1 · PRODUCTION TASK 1

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Corrective do to express a correction to an explicit or implied denial, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F2 · PRODUCTION TASK 2

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Contrastive complement to express a strong contrast between two evaluated qualities, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F3 · PRODUCTION TASK 3

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Object topicalisation to express an established topic placed before the comment, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

Final self-check

Complete these prompts without reopening the guide.

R1 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: communicative purpose.

_____
_____
_____

R2 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: structural trigger.

_____
_____
_____

R3 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: meaning contrast.

_____
_____
_____

R4 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: register choice.

_____
_____
_____

Recognition in context

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

A1

The first proposal did address the immediate risk.

Corrective do is the best match because a correction to an explicit or implied denial.

A2

Useful the guide may be, but complete it is not.

Contrastive complement is the best match because a strong contrast between two evaluated qualities.

A3

This limitation, we cannot ignore.

Object topicalisation is the best match because an established topic placed before the comment.

A4

a correction to an explicit or implied denial

The Corrective do pattern communicates a correction to an explicit or implied denial.

A5

a strong contrast between two evaluated qualities

The Contrastive complement pattern communicates a strong contrast between two evaluated qualities.

A6

an established topic placed before the comment

The Object topicalisation pattern communicates an established topic placed before the comment.

Form and function

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

B1

Corrective do / a correction to an explicit or implied denial

The structure belongs to the Corrective do pattern. Its communicative purpose is a correction to an explicit or implied denial.

B2

Contrastive complement / a strong contrast between two evaluated qualities

The structure belongs to the Contrastive complement pattern. Its communicative purpose is a strong contrast between two evaluated qualities.

B3

Object topicalisation / an established topic placed before the comment

The structure belongs to the Object topicalisation pattern. Its communicative purpose is an established topic placed before the comment.

Guided discourse choices

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

C1

The first proposal did address the immediate risk.

Corrective do: do/does/did + base verb.

C2

Useful the guide may be, but complete it is not.

Contrastive complement: complement + subject + verb.

C3

This limitation, we cannot ignore.

Object topicalisation: object + subject + verb.

C4

The first proposal did address the immediate risk.

Corrective do: do/does/did + base verb.

C5

Useful the guide may be, but complete it is not.

Contrastive complement: complement + subject + verb.

C6

This limitation, we cannot ignore.

Object topicalisation: object + subject + verb.

Open reconstruction

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

D1

did address

Corrective do requires “did address” in this model. do/does/did + base verb.

D2

Useful the guide may be

Contrastive complement requires “Useful the guide may be” in this model. complement + subject + verb.

D3

This limitation

Object topicalisation requires “This limitation” in this model. object + subject + verb.

D4

do/does/did + base verb

Corrective do is built as do/does/did + base verb.

D5

complement + subject + verb

Contrastive complement is built as complement + subject + verb.

Controlled transformation

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

E1

The first proposal did address the immediate risk.

do/does/did + base verb. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended corrective do effect.

E2

Useful the guide may be, but complete it is not.

complement + subject + verb. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended contrastive complement effect.

E3

This limitation, we cannot ignore.

object + subject + verb. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended object topicalisation effect.

E4

The first proposal did address the immediate risk.

do/does/did + base verb. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended corrective do effect.

Communicative production

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

F1

The first proposal did address the immediate risk. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses do/does/did + base verb accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F2

Useful the guide may be, but complete it is not. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses complement + subject + verb accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F3

This limitation, we cannot ignore. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses object + subject + verb accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

Diagnose the pattern, not only the score

Use this page to decide what to revisit in the complete guide.

CHECK · TRIGGER OR CONTEXT

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · AUXILIARY OR STRUCTURAL CHOICE

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MAIN VERB OR CLAUSE FORM

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MEANING AND REGISTER

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____